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Fortress, stronghold, castle, citadel, fort

3.13.3.2 Fortress, stronghold, castle, citadel, fort

References:

Hebrew בִּירָה (birah) 2CH 17:12, 2CH 27:4, NEH 2:8, NEH 7:2

Hebrew מִבְצָר (mivtsar) 2SA 24:7, 2KI 8:12, PSA 89:41, ISA 17:3, ISA 34:13, JER 48:18, LAM 2:2, LAM 2:5, DAN 11:39, HOS 10:14, AMO 5:9, MIC 5:10, NAM 3:12, NAM 3:14, HAB 1:10

Hebrew מִגְדַּל־שְׁכֶם (migdal shkem) JDG 9:46, JDG 9:47, JDG 9:49

Hebrew מִסְגֶּרֶת (misgereth) 2SA 22:46, PSA 18:46, MIC 7:17

Hebrew מָעוֹז (maʿoz) ISA 23:11, DAN 11:7, DAN 11:10, DAN 11:10, DAN 11:19, DAN 11:31, DAN 11:38, DAN 11:39

Hebrew מָצָד, מְצוּדָה (mtsad, mtsudah) 2SA 5:7, 2SA 5:9, 1CH 11:5, 1CH 11:7, JER 48:41, JER 51:30

Hebrew מָצוֹר (matsor) ZEC 9:3

Hebrew מְצוּרָה (mtsurah) 2CH 11:11, 2CH 11:23, 2CH 12:4, 2CH 14:5, 2CH 21:3

Hebrew מִשְׂגָּב (misgav) 2SA 22:3, PSA 9:10, PSA 9:10, PSA 18:3, PSA 46:8, PSA 46:12, PSA 48:4, PSA 59:10, PSA 59:17, PSA 59:18, PSA 62:3, PSA 62:7, PSA 94:22, PSA 144:2, ISA 25:12, ISA 33:16, JER 48:1

Hebrew צְרִיחַ (tsariach) JDG 9:46, JDG 9:49, JDG 9:49

Greek ἀκρόπολις (akropolis) 2MA 4:12, 2MA 4:28, 2MA 5:5

Greek ἄκρα (akra) 1MA 1:33, 1MA 3:45, 1MA 4:2, 1MA 4:41, 1MA 6:18, 1MA 6:26, 1MA 6:32, 1MA 9:52, 1MA 9:53, 1MA 10:7, 1MA 10:7, 1MA 10:9, 1MA 10:32, 1MA 11:21, 1MA 11:21, 1MA 11:41, 1MA 12:36, 1MA 13:21, 1MA 13:50, 1MA 13:50, 1MA 13:52, 1MA 14:7, 1MA 14:36, 1MA 15:28, 2MA 15:31, 2MA 15:35, 4MA 4:20

Greek βάρις (baris) 1ES 6:22

Greek ὀχύρωμα, ὀχυρωμάτιον (ochurōma, ochurōmation) 2CO 10:4, 1MA 1:2, 1MA 4:61, 1MA 5:9, 1MA 5:11, 1MA 5:27, 1MA 5:29, 1MA 5:30, 1MA 5:65, 1MA 6:61, 1MA 6:62, 1MA 8:10, 1MA 9:50, 1MA 10:12, 1MA 10:37, 1MA 11:18, 1MA 11:18, 1MA 11:41, 1MA 12:33, 1MA 12:34, 1MA 12:35, 1MA 12:45, 1MA 13:33, 1MA 13:33, 1MA 13:38, 1MA 14:42, 1MA 15:7, 1MA 16:8, 1MA 16:15, 2MA 8:30, 2MA 10:15, 2MA 10:16, 2MA 10:23, 2MA 10:32, 2MA 11:6, 2MA 12:19, 3MA 6:25

Greek φρούριον (frourion) 2MA 10:32, 2MA 10:33, 2MA 13:19

Description:

Model of the Antonia fortress in Jerusalem (© Ray Pritz by United Bible Societies)The fortress was a large fortification, often part of the defense of a town. In the Middle East such fortifications were built of stone. A fortress could consist of one extra strong building or of a complex of buildings surrounded by its own strong wall.

Translation:

In some languages the word “fortress” may be rendered in terms of its function, for example, “place for protection” or “place to defend oneself.” Often, however, a fortress is described in terms of its construction, for example, “strong-walled place.”

The Hebrew word *birah* in NEH 2:8; NEH 7:2 refers to a fortified enclosure that stood on the northwest corner of the Temple complex in Jerusalem to guard the Temple on the northern side, from which attacks were most likely to come. It was later expanded and strengthened by Herod the Great and named the Antonia (see 3.20.1 Pavement, The Pavement<REALIA:3.20.1>).

In NEH 2:8CEV renders the literal phrase “the fortress of the Temple” as “the fortress near the temple”; GNT has “the fort that guards the Temple”; REB says “the citadel, which adjoins the temple.”

The Hebrew phrase *migdal shkem* in JDG 9:47; JDG 9:47; JDG 9:49 is understood in various ways. Most English translations consulted have “tower of Shechem” or “fortress of Shechem”; some capitalize “Tower” (RSV), suggesting that it could be a place name. Many non-English translations (for example, SPCL, FRCL, DUCL, TOB) take it to be a place name and simply transliterate it (DUCL “Migdal-Sichem”).

In the New Testament the Greek term *ochurōma* occurs only in 2CO 10:4, where it is used figuratively of the strength of false arguments. In a number of languages it may be more satisfactory to render the word in a simile in order to mark this figurative usage; for example, the verse may be rendered “The weapons we use in our fight are not the world’s weapons but God’s powerful weapons with which to destroy false arguments in the same way that people would destroy fortresses.”